What Makes a Strong Project?

NASA Space Apps Cairo 2026 — Judging Guidelines for Participants

Your project will be evaluated based on five main criteria. Keep these points in mind while developing your solution and preparing your final submission.

1. Impact – Make a Difference

- Address a meaningful real-world problem.
- Explain who could benefit from your solution and how.
- Show the potential positive impact of your project on people, science, society, Earth, or space exploration.

Ask yourself: *Why does this project matter, and who will benefit from it?*

2. Creativity – Think Outside the Box

- Bring an original idea or a fresh perspective to an existing problem.
- Introduce an innovative approach or improve an existing solution.
- Use available technologies and resources in meaningful and inventive ways.

Ask yourself: *What makes our solution different or innovative?*

3. Validity – Build a Feasible Solution

- Base your solution on sound scientific and technical principles.
- Make sure your proposed solution can realistically work.
- Demonstrate how it works through appropriate evidence, testing, a prototype, a model, or a demonstration, where applicable.
- Support your claims with reliable information and results.

Ask yourself: *Does our solution actually work, and can we justify how it works?*

4. Relevance – Solve the Right Challenge

- Clearly address the objectives of your selected NASA challenge.
- Use relevant NASA data and resources meaningfully in developing your solution.
- Show how NASA data contributes to your approach and supports your proposed solution.
- Make sure your project responds to the actual problem described in the challenge.

Ask yourself: *Does our project genuinely solve the selected challenge, and how does NASA data contribute to it?*

5. Presentation – Tell Your Story

- Clearly explain the problem you are solving and why it matters.
- Describe your proposed solution and how it works.
- Present your approach, methodology, and results in an organized way.
- Use clear visuals, demonstrations, prototypes, or supporting materials where appropriate.
- Communicate your project's value and potential impact effectively.

Ask yourself: *Can someone understand our problem, solution, and its importance through our presentation and submitted materials?*

Remember!

A strong project is not just a creative idea. It should address a meaningful problem, offer a relevant and feasible solution, make meaningful use of NASA resources, demonstrate its potential value, and communicate it clearly. Focus on all five criteria when developing your project.

Before Submitting Your Project

Make sure you:

- ☐ Have selected and addressed a NASA challenge.
- ☐ Have meaningfully incorporated relevant NASA Open Data and Resources.
- ☐ Have developed a clear and feasible proposed solution.
- ☐ Have prepared the required project description and supporting materials.
- ☐ Have checked that all submitted links are accessible.
- ☐ Have followed the official project submission instructions, including applicable AI-use disclosure and content requirements.